

Lutosławski had long opposed the Soviet regime, his music had never been overtly political, but it was increasingly seen as symbolic of Polish nationalism. With the rise of union organizer Lech Wałęsa's Solidarność (Solidarity) movement in 1980, he became more politically involved, lending his support to Solidarność by refusing any engagements in Poland until independence. However, he carried on composing, and created many of his finest works in the last decade of his life. He died of cancer in 1994.



FESTIVAL OF MUSIC

In this photograph, Lutosławski is seen conducting at the 16th International Festival of Contemporary Music in Poland in September 1972.